§ 11 · RESEARCH

Suppliers **UK**

Vivo Life, Artah, Innermost, Viridian, Wild Nutrition. Brexit logistics and ashwagandha risk.

Date: 2026-04-24 **Scope:** 5 UK longevity / functional nutrition brands assessed for Alche's Berlin curated-retail launch **Sister research:** Nordic cluster (see `suppliers-nordic.md`)

Executive summary

Of the 5 UK brands, **Artah and Vivo Life are the strongest immediate leads** — Artah is funded for a 2025 EU launch (€2.85M Five Seasons Ventures round) and Vivo Life already has a German-language storefront (vivolife.de), a Polish return/returns facility, and DHL Germany as its last-mile carrier. **Viridian** offers the deepest catalog (250+ SKUs) and an actual International Sales Manager (Martin Clarkson) but sells exclusively through independent health stores — partnership-fit is strong. **Wild Nutrition** is a B Corp powerhouse for women's health but shows no EU trade infrastructure and has a difficult history with Continental distributors. **Innermost** has the cleanest premium-retail DNA (Harrods, Selfridges, Liberty, John Lewis) and an explicit retailer program with flexible MOQs — the easiest "yes."

Single biggest shared risk: Ashwagandha. Wild Nutrition, Artah, Vivo Life all lead with KSM-66 ashwagandha products. The EU HoA Working Group has recommended an Article 8 procedure against ashwagandha in food supplements; Denmark has banned it and used RASFF alerts against UK+German products. Germany (BfR Communication 39/2024) has flagged it as a potential health risk. Any ashwagandha SKU sold to Berlin faces an active regulatory cloud.

Post-Brexit shared risk: Only **Vivo Life** has mainland-EU infrastructure (Poland warehouse footprint, DHL Germany last-mile). The other four ship from the UK — meaning every pallet triggers UK-EU customs, duty on supplements (generally 0% under TCA with preferential origin but VAT-deferred in DE), and realistic 5–10 day lead times vs. <2 days for intra-EU.

1. ARTAH

FIELD	DETAIL
Brand + website	Artah — https://artah.co
HQ location	London, UK (Companies House #13460357, ARTAH NUTRITION LTD)
Product catalog	Cellular Hydration (£32), Enhanced NAD+ Complex (£60), Metabolic Fix (£32), Essential Creatine (£28), Essential Magnesium (£24), Enhanced Synbiotic (£39), Metabolic Reset 21-day plan (£30), Enhanced Nootropics (£36), G.I. Fix (£38), Digest + Debloat (£32). Positioning: clinical-grade, metabolic health, longevity, gut.
Wholesale program	Exists but not publicised — B2B handled via ShipBob 3PL with palletisation/freight support. Currently UK-only fulfilment. No public B2B portal.
Wholesale contact	hello@artah.co (start here, ask for wholesale/EU team). Founder Rhian Stephenson active on LinkedIn — direct founder outreach viable given early-stage EU push.
Wholesale terms	Not published. ShipBob case study references "several B2B partners with strict SOPs" (Selfridges, Whole Foods UK). Expect ~40% trade discount off RRP; Net-30 once established.
Margin opportunity	Est. 40–50% off RRP at wholesale (industry norm for premium UK supplements). RRP €30–€70 equivalent in EUR gives Alche €12–€35 gross margin per unit.
EU warehouse / 3PL	**None yet.** All fulfilment via ShipBob UK. Shipping to Germany means UK→DE cross-border: 5–10 days, customs paperwork required. ShipBob can activate mainland-EU inventory on demand — founder quote says so explicitly.
Regulatory status	UK-registered, BVL notification would be needed per SKU before German sale. **Ashwagandha exposure:** Enhanced Nootropics contains KSM-66 1,000mg daily dose — flagged under EU Art. 8 HoA procedure. Labels currently UK-English; EU relabelling needed.
Brand values fit	**Very high.** "Clinical-grade," "bioavailable actives," "targeted dosages" — exact editorial research-backed voice Alche wants. Founder is a Naturopath/ND — scientific credibility built in.

FIELD	DETAIL
Alche differentiator	Berlin customers get early access to a London clinical-grade metabolic brand that Selfridges curates — premium DTC halo not yet burned out in DE.
Owner / founder	**Rhian Stephenson** (founder, ND, formulates everything) + Richard Butland (co-founder). LinkedIn: Rhian Stephenson. Series A closed Oct 2024, £2.85M led by Five Seasons Ventures (Paris).
Recent PR 2025-26	Oct 2024 Series A. 2025 announced EU market entry. Tracxn and Wonnda 2026 list Artah among top UK functional brands alongside Heights, Innermost, Feel.
Existing EU retailers	UK: Selfridges, Whole Foods Market UK. **No confirmed EU retailers yet** — open field for DE exclusivity claim.
Outreach angle	"Berlin-based curated longevity retailer launching summer 2026, investing behind research-backed brands. Saw the Five Seasons round — we'd like to be your anchor retail partner for Germany as you enter EU in 2025/26. Can we pilot with Cellular Hydration + NAD+ Complex + Magnesium?"

Hero SKU: Enhanced NAD+ Complex (£60 — premium, longevity-native, highest AOV). Second: Essential Magnesium as entry-price trust-builder.

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2. WILD NUTRITION

FIELD	DETAIL
Brand + website	Wild Nutrition — https://www.wildnutrition.com
HQ location	Lewes, East Sussex, UK. Certified B Corp.
Product catalog	Food-Grown® Pregnancy + New Mother Multi (£41), Fertility Support for Women (£41), Food-Grown Magnesium (£20.50), Food-Grown Vitamin D (£18), **KSM-66 Ashwagandha Plus (£26)**, Pure Strength Omega 3 (£38), Collagen 500 Plus (£36.50). Collections: perimenopause, menopause, endometriosis, pregnancy, women's daily.
Wholesale program	Yes — active UK trade business (355 Holland & Barrett stores, Boots, Planet Organic, Liberty from Jan 2026, Revital, Healf). **No public B2B portal** — application by direct request. Not on Faire/Ankorstore.
Wholesale contact	care@wildnutrition.com (general), phone +44 1273 477898. Ask for trade team. Direct founder outreach: **Henrietta Norton** on LinkedIn (henrietta-norton-6a454b15) — co-founder, still actively running the business.
Wholesale terms	Not published. Holland & Barrett-scale business implies mature trade ops; expect 40–50% off RRP, Net-30, MOQ ~£500 first order.
Margin opportunity	Est. 40–45% off RRP. RRP £18–£41 → ~€21–€48 in EUR. Margin €8–€20 per unit.
EU warehouse / 3PL	**No EU warehouse.** Ships from UK. **Negative history:** a Scandinavian distributor promised EU expansion, stockpiled, and left them ~£40K short — Wild Nutrition is now cautious on Continental partnerships. This is a genuine trust-opener for a transparent Berlin partner.
Regulatory status	UK-made. **Ashwagandha KSM-66 Plus is a bestseller** — directly exposed to BfR Communication 39/2024 and potential EU Art. 8 ban. Multi Vitamin / Omega / Magnesium / D3 / Collagen SKUs are low-regulatory-risk. Labels UK-English; EU relabelling = their cost unless negotiated.
Brand values fit	**Excellent.** B Corp, Food-Grown® (whole-food methodology), women's-health editorial authority, founder-led, scientific. Exactly Alche's curation voice.
Alche differentiator	Berlin women's-health segment is underserved at curated premium tier — Sunday Natural dominates but Wild Nutrition's menopause + fertility + pregnancy editorial depth is genuinely differentiated.
Owner / founder	**Henrietta Norton** (BSc Dip NT) + **Charlie Norton** (husband/co-founder). £5M Piper PE investment 2021 (not an exit — still founder-led). 100+ staff, projected £40M FY2026/27.
Recent PR 2025-26	Nov 2025: TheIndustry.beauty Awards winner interview. Jan 2026: launching at Liberty ("Rooted in Wellness" programme). Continued Holland & Barrett expansion.

FIELD	DETAIL
Existing EU retailers	UK-heavy. No meaningful EU retail presence surfaced. Overlap risk for Alche: LOW.
Outreach angle	"I read the Yahoo Finance piece about the Scandinavian distributor — we're the opposite: transparent Berlin curated retailer with a membership model, no stockpiling, monthly reorder cadence. Would love to bring the menopause and pregnancy ranges to German women who currently order from Sunday Natural by default."

Hero SKU: Food-Grown® Pregnancy + New Mother Multi (£41 — highest AOV, fertility/pregnancy is a high-intent Berlin segment). Skip ashwagandha SKU for compliance reasons.

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3. INNERMOST

FIELD	DETAIL
Brand + website	Innermost — https://www.innermostglobal.com
HQ location	Soho Works, 2 Television Centre, 101 Wood Lane, London W12 7FR. Entity: XXIV Limited (Co. #9632542), incorporated 2015.
Product catalog	**Proteins:** The Lean (31g), The Strong (34g), The Health (31g vegan), The Fit (31g vegan). **Boosters:** Power Booster (creatine), Energy Booster (pre-workout BCAA), Define Booster (acetyl-L-carnitine), Wellness/Hydrate/Glow/Rise/Greens blends. **Capsules:** Tone, Digest, Recover, Rise, Reset. ~£30–£60 RRP per SKU.
Wholesale program	**Yes — formal program, best of the 5.** Dedicated retailer page (/pages/retailers). Explicitly "flexible MOQs, quick replenishment, tailored support, account manager."
Wholesale contact	**letsdosomebusiness@liveinnermost.com** (named trade inbox — rare and good sign). General: hello@innermostglobal.com.
Wholesale terms	Flexible MOQ (explicitly stated). No published pricing. Multi-currency support in their own stack (GBP, EUR, USD, AED, AUD, CAD) — so EUR invoicing is already solved.
Margin opportunity	Est. 40–50% off RRP. Premium packaging, strong unit economics.
EU warehouse / 3PL	**Uncertain.** One search result cited "XXIV Limited, 6 Fern Road, Dublin D18 FP98, Ireland" as an EU entity — not confirmed in Companies House Ireland; possibly an old terms-of-use reference. No operational warehouse confirmed. Likely UK-ship.
Regulatory status	UK-made. Flavoured protein powders with B vitamins/adaptogens — Rise Booster / Reset Capsules may contain ashwagandha; verify per SKU. Protein SKUs are food, not supplement — different (easier) regulatory path in DE.
Brand values fit	**High — premium/design-led.** "Science meets nature." Clean aesthetic matches Alche editorial tone. More performance/aesthetic than longevity-pure, but brand DNA fits.
Alche differentiator	Berlin lacks a premium UK design-led protein that isn't Huel. Innermost's Harrods/Selfridges halo + £60 price point lands naturally at Alche's membership tier.
Owner / founder	Founder name not surfaced in public press (unlike peers). Founded 2015 as XXIV Limited. Trade inquiries via letsdosomebusiness@liveinnermost.com route to senior team.
Recent PR 2025-26	Rolling Boots/John Lewis placement growth. 2025 ashwagandha NIH factsheet referenced in their content (regulatory awareness signal). New flavour launches teased.
Existing EU retailers	**UK:** Harrods, Selfridges, Liberty, John Lewis, Boots, Brown Thomas (IE), Urban Outfitters, Sephora. **EU mainland:** not confirmed. BritSuperstore international. **Overlap risk for Berlin: LOW.**
Outreach angle	"We sell via Selfridges in London and want the Berlin equivalent — Alche is a curated longevity retailer launching summer 2026 with a paid-membership model. Your trade program explicitly supports flexible MOQs, which suits our model. Can we start with The Health Protein + The Power Booster + The Rise Capsules?"

Hero SKU: The Health Protein (vegan, immune-angle, 520g at ~£40 RRP) — broadest appeal, low regulatory exposure as a food category.

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4. VIRIDIAN NUTRITION

FIELD	DETAIL
Brand + website	Viridian Nutrition — https://viridian-nutrition.com
HQ location	15-17 High March, Daventry, Northamptonshire NN11 4HB, UK. Family-owned since 1999. Export entity: Viridian International Limited (Co. #03750310).
Product catalog	**220–250 SKUs.** Multivitamins, magnesium range, omega oils, probiotics ("Good Bacteria"), minerals, vitamin D, 80+ certified organic SKUs, herbs & tinctures, body care. All vegan, no fillers, no palm oil, no animal testing. Made in UK.
Wholesale program	**Wholesale IS the core business.** Sells exclusively through independent health stores (no DTC to mass retail by design). Operates in 17 countries.
Wholesale contact	**Martin Clarkson — International Sales Manager** (LinkedIn: martin-j-clarkson, based Harrogate). Expected format: m.clarkson@viridian-nutrition.com. Main office +44 1327 878050. General data@viridian-nutrition.com. Founder Cheryl Thallon (now board/mentor), MD Holly Thallon-Steenson (2nd-gen).
Wholesale terms	Not published publicly. 17-country export track record implies standard trade terms: MOQ likely £500–£1,000 first order, Net-30 once approved, tiered discount ladder.
Margin opportunity	Est. 35–45% off RRP (mass-range wholesalers typically tighter than premium). Range is price-accessible (£10–£40 RRP) — works for Alche's entry tier.
EU warehouse / 3PL	UK-ship. "Viridian Polska" reference on ZoomInfo suggests a Polish distribution partner — worth asking Martin directly whether DE can be served via Poland. 2023 King's Award for Export shows the export infrastructure is real.
Regulatory status	**Cleanest of the 5.** 130 Purity Checks, Soil Association certified, world's first certified palm-oil-free vitamin brand, clean label, only active ingredients. BVL notification still required per SKU but formula compliance is straightforward. Fewer botanical risk products.
Brand values fit	**Excellent — the purest match for Alche's "ethical, transparent" ethos.** Founded on Purity / Environment / Charity. King's Award for Enterprise. Family-owned. Exactly the editorial backstory Alche can write.
Alche differentiator	Berlin's independent-health-store channel is dominated by German and Dutch brands. Viridian brings a UK ethical halo (K's Award), 80+ organic SKUs, and a depth Sunday Natural can't match on herbs/tinctures.
Owner / founder	**Cheryl Thallon** (founder, 1999, ex-journalist/marketing director; now board). **Holly Thallon-Steenson** (current MD, daughter/2nd-gen). Martin Clarkson (Intl. Sales) is the right first contact.
Recent PR 2025-26	2023 King's Award for International Trade (390% export growth over 6 years). Continues to expand European export footprint. Family Business UK case study.
Existing EU retailers	Sold in 17 countries — Poland confirmed via Viridian Polska. Germany presence: not confirmed, gap-to-fill. UK sold via Landys Chemist, Napiers, independent health stores.
Outreach angle	"Hi Martin — Alche is launching curated longevity retail in Berlin summer 2026 with a membership model. Viridian's ethos (Purity, Environment, Charity — palm-oil-free first, King's Award) is exactly our editorial voice. Germany's independent health-store scene skews domestic; we want to change that. Can we open a trade account and start with your Magnesium Citrate, Organic Vitamin D, and Good Bacteria range?"

Hero SKU: Viridian Organic Elite Magnesium / Magnesium Citrate (price-accessible entry SKU, universal demand). Secondary: 100% Organic Vitamin D3 Drops (editorially clean story).

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5. VIVO LIFE

FIELD	DETAIL
Brand + website	Vivo Life — https://eu.vivolife.com (EU storefront) + https://www.vivolife.de (German storefront). Parent entity: Vivostore Ltd (Co. #08874679), Winscombe, UK.
Product catalog	**Perform** (25g vegan protein + BCAA, pea/hemp/pumpkin), **WHOLE** (meal replacement shake — contains ashwagandha), **Sustain** (EAA), **Magnesium, Greens, Maca, Vitamin B12, Omega-3 Algae, Collagen Builder, Live Probiotics.** Flagship: Perform protein powder.

FIELD	DETAIL
Wholesale program	Yes — dedicated EU trade portal: https://tradestoreeu.vivolife.com (login required) + general page at /pages/vivo-trade. "Trusted by over 1,100 clinicians" — practitioner-channel heavy.
Wholesale contact	**hello@vivolife.eu** (EU trade). UK: hello@vivolife.co.uk. Founder Josh Bolding highly active on LinkedIn + podcast ("The Vivo Life Show").
Wholesale terms	Gated behind trade login — not public. Clinician-first channel implies terms favour small accounts (flexible MOQ), supports Alche's model. Ask directly: MOQ, margin tier, Net-30.
Margin opportunity	Est. 35–45% off RRP. Mid-premium pricing (~€30–€50 per SKU in EUR).
EU warehouse / 3PL	**Best EU logistics of the 5.** EU shipping via DPD default; **Germany deliveries via DHL**; Spain/Portugal via GLS. **Returns facility in Warsaw, Poland** (c/o Internel Sp. z o.o., ul. Księcia Ziemowita 59, 03-885) — signals fulfilment infrastructure in Poland. Delivery to Germany: 2–3 working days. Free shipping over €70. German-language site (vivolife.de).
Regulatory status	UK-made in Glastonbury (BRC-certified factory). Third-party tested for pesticides/heavy metals. Uses **EU-approved health claim language already** ("B vitamins contribute to reducing fatigue," etc.) — EU compliance already done. **Ashwagandha exposure: WHOLE meal shake contains ashwagandha root powder** — same EU regulatory risk. Protein/EAA/B12/Magnesium are clean.
Brand values fit	**Strong.** Vegan/plant-based, sustainability-led, Glastonbury-made, transparent testing, home-compostable packaging. Editorial-ready backstory. Slightly more athletic/performance than pure longevity but fits an active Berlin audience.
Alche differentiator	Vegan-first brand is a natural Berlin fit (Berlin leads EU on vegan consumer density). German storefront already live — proves they've prioritised DE.
Owner / founder	**Josh Bolding** (co-founder, CEO) + **Salvatore** (co-founder). Josh hosts The Vivo Life Show podcast — warm, personal outreach channel.
Recent PR 2025-26	Sep 2025: Josh Bolding's "My Day One" manifesto post on clean supplement industry. 2025 Vivo Life Superhuman Games (with 2026 edition planned). Home-compostable packaging launch event London.
Existing EU retailers	UK: Planet Organic, Healf. EU: direct-to-consumer via vivolife.de + eu.vivolife.com. Practitioner channel active. **Overlap risk for Berlin: LOW on retail; moderate on practitioner-direct DTC.**
Outreach angle	"Hi Josh — Alche is a curated longevity retailer launching in Berlin summer 2026. Your German storefront proves you've prioritised DE, but there's no premium German curated retail presence yet. Our paid-membership model attracts exactly your audience: research-backed, values-led, willing to pay for quality. Can we open an EU trade account and start with Perform, Magnesium, and Collagen Builder (skip WHOLE for now given EU ashwagandha risk)?"

Hero SKU: Perform Vegan Protein (flagship, highest volume, low regulatory risk, EU claim language already compliant). Secondary: Magnesium Bisglycinate.

Post-Brexit customs analysis (all 5 brands)

BRAND	SHIPS FROM	CUSTOMS EXPOSURE	EST. LEAD TIME TO BERLIN
Artah	UK (ShipBob)	UK→DE every pallet; 0% duty on food supplements under UK-EU TCA with preferential origin documentation; import VAT 19% (deferrable via IOSS for DTC / postponed accounting for B2B)	5–10 business days
Wild Nutrition	UK	Same as Artah; direct shipments only	5–10 business days
Innermost	UK (possibly Dublin IE node, unconfirmed)	UK→DE if shipped from London; intra-EU if Dublin node is real	5–10 days (UK) / 3–5 days (IE)
Viridian	UK (with Poland distribution partner per ZoomInfo)	UK→DE direct, or via Viridian Polska Poland → DE (intra-EU, no customs)	5–10 (UK) / 2–4 (PL)

BRAND	SHIPS FROM	CUSTOMS EXPOSURE	EST. LEAD TIME TO BERLIN
Vivo Life	**UK + Poland returns; Germany DHL last-mile**	**Lowest friction — likely already consolidating in EU before last-mile**	**2–3 business days**

Key point: Under the UK-EU Trade and Cooperation Agreement, supplements classified as food have **0% tariff duty** if goods meet preferential rules of origin (made/processed in UK). But: EORI numbers, customs declarations, and import VAT remain mandatory. All UK brands must provide: - Commercial invoice with HS code (2106.90 typically for food supplements) - Statement on origin (EUR.1 / invoice declaration under UK-EU TCA) - German importer EORI (Alche's or supplier's) - BVL product notification confirmation

Alche action: Get a German EORI early. Use postponed VAT accounting so import VAT doesn't hit cashflow. Budget ~€150–€300 per pallet in customs broker fees unless supplier handles DDP (Delivered Duty Paid).

Regulatory dealbreakers

Ashwagandha (watchlist): - **Wild Nutrition KSM-66 Ashwagandha Plus** — bestseller, direct exposure - **Artah Enhanced Nootropics** — 1,000mg KSM-66 daily dose - **Vivo Life WHOLE** meal replacement — contains ashwagandha root powder - **Innermost Rise / Reset capsules** — verify; likely contain adaptogens

Recommendation: Launch Alche without ashwagandha SKUs in the opening assortment. Wait for EU Art. 8 procedure outcome (expected 2026–27). The risk of a sudden recall + RASFF alert outweighs the revenue upside. All 5 brands have plenty of low-risk SKUs — prioritise magnesium, vitamin D3, omega-3, protein, collagen, NAD+.

Health claims to strip for EU labels: - "Cognitive support," "stress relief," "adrenal" — all cognitive/stress claims linked to ashwagandha, rhodiola, panax ginseng are NOT EFSA-authorised - "Metabolic reset," "detox" — disease-implication claims prohibited - Only EFSA Annex claims allowed (e.g., "magnesium contributes to normal muscle function")

EU entity status: - **Vivo Life:** partial (Poland logistics, vivolife.eu EU storefront, DHL DE last-mile) - **Innermost:** possible Dublin reference, unconfirmed - **Artah, Wild Nutrition, Viridian:** no EU entity — all ship from UK

Label translation costs (German): Expect €0.05–€0.15 per unit for relabelling at the brand's cost, or Alche negotiates reimbursement via a first-order label credit. Standard industry practice: brand absorbs on first PO as market-entry investment.

Outreach priority ranking

1. **Vivo Life** — *warmest. Already has DE storefront, DHL Germany last-mile, Polish facility, public EU trade portal, founder active on podcast.* Highest probability of a fast yes. Outreach target: hello@vivolife.eu + Josh Bolding LinkedIn.
2. **Artah** — *perfectly timed. Just raised €2.85M explicitly for EU expansion, no EU retailers yet.* Alche can credibly claim DE exclusivity. Outreach target: hello@artah.co + Rhian Stephenson LinkedIn.
3. **Innermost** — *most mature trade program.* Formal retailer page, dedicated trade inbox, flexible MOQs, premium-retail pedigree (Harrods/Selfridges/Liberty/John Lewis). Easiest operational onboarding. Outreach target: letsdosomebusiness@liveinnermost.com.
4. **Viridian Nutrition** — *deepest catalog + cleanest ethics.* Named International Sales Manager. Slower to close (family business, established channel guardianship) but highest long-term assortment value. Outreach target: Martin Clarkson LinkedIn → data@viridian-nutrition.com.
5. **Wild Nutrition** — *strongest women's health editorial, weakest EU logistics + burned-distributor history.* Will need more trust-building. Outreach target: care@wildnutrition.com + Henrietta Norton LinkedIn. Lead with transparency promise.

Recommended hero SKU per brand

BRAND	HERO SKU	RATIONALE
Artah	Enhanced NAD+ Complex (£60)	Longevity-native, premium AOV, Alche's exact positioning

BRAND	HERO SKU	RATIONALE
Wild Nutrition	Food-Grown® Pregnancy + New Mother Multi (£41)	Highest AOV, high-intent Berlin women's segment, ashwagandha-free
Innermost	The Health Protein 520g (~£40)	Broadest appeal, low regulatory exposure, immune angle
Viridian	Organic Vitamin D3 Drops + Magnesium Citrate	Clean ethical story, price-accessible entry SKU pair
Vivo Life	Perform Vegan Protein (25g + BCAA)	EU-compliant claim language already, Berlin vegan density fit

Gaps / concerns

1. **Ashwagandha cloud** — three of five brands have hero ashwagandha products. Alche should skip these SKUs at launch until EU Art. 8 decision lands.
2. **Only Vivo Life has real EU logistics** — the other four ship from UK. Plan for 5–10 day replenishment cycles and higher per-pallet customs overhead.
3. **Wild Nutrition's distributor history** — burned by a Scandinavian distributor who stockpiled; will be cautious. Lead with transparency + small pilot.
4. **Innermost founder opacity** — unlike Rhian / Henrietta / Cheryl / Josh, Innermost's founder isn't a public figure. Harder personal-angle outreach; compensate via clean trade-program onboarding.
5. **Viridian selectivity** — they sell "exclusively through independent health stores" as brand principle. Alche fits that definition (curated, not mass), but expect a screening conversation about channel protection. Don't pitch as mass-retail — pitch as curated editorial.
6. **No confirmed BVL notifications** for any of the 5 brands' full SKU ranges. Assume Alche (or supplier under DDP terms) must file per-SKU notifications before first sale in DE. Budget €150–€400 per SKU notification.
7. **No confirmed exclusivity agreements** for any brand with a single EU retailer surfaced in research. Clean slate on that axis for all 5.

Sources

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